

1. Not so locked in any more

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-14T22:53:49+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/14/not-so-locked-in/#atom-everything>

This Mitchell Hashimoto quote about Bun migrating from Zig to Rust reminded me of a similar conversation I had at a conference last week. I was talking to someone who worked for a medium sized technology company with a pair of legacy/ legendary iPhone and Android apps. They told me they had just completed a coding-agent driven rewrite of both apps to React Native. I asked why they chose that, given that coding agents presumably drive down the cost of maintaining separate iPhone and Android apps. They said that React Native has improved a lot over the past few years and covered everything their apps needed to do. And... if it turned out to be the wrong decision, they could just port back to native in the future. Like Mitchell said: Programming languages used to be LOCK IN, and they're increasingly not so. Tags: react , coding-agents , ai-assisted-programming , generative-ai , ai , llms

2. Quoting Mitchell Hashimoto

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-14T22:31:20+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/14/mitchell-hashimoto/#atom-everything>

[...] On the interesting side is how fungible programming languages are nowadays. Programming languages used to be LOCK IN, and they're increasingly not so. You think the Bun rewrite in Rust is good for Rust? Bun has shown they can be in probably any language they want in roughly a week or two. Rust is expendable. Its useful until its not then it can be thrown out. That's interesting! ? Mitchell Hashimoto , on Bun porting from Zig to Rust Tags: zig , ai , mitchell-hashimoto , llms , rust , generative-ai , agentic-engineering , bun

3. datasette-ip-rate-limit 0.1a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-14T04:10:23+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/14/datasette-ip-rate-limit/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-ip-rate-limit 0.1a0 The datasette.io site was being hammered by poorly-behaved crawlers, so I had Codex (GPT-5.5 xhigh) build a configurable rate limiting plugin to block IPs that were hammering specific areas of the site too quickly. Here's the production configuration I'm using on that site for the new plugin: datasette-ip-rate-limit : header : Fly-Client-IP max_keys : 10000 exempt_paths : - " /static/* " - " /-turnstile* " rules : - name : demo-databases paths : - " /global-power-plants/* " - " /legislators/* " window_seconds : 60 max_requests : 60 block_seconds : 20 Tags: datasette , rate-limiting , codex

4. ?Musk v. Altman? Closing Arguments

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-15T00:57:38Z

Link: https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/931006/musk-v-altman-closing-argument-s-analysis?view_token=eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiJ9.eyJpZCI6ImhxZzBnTXFpSk8iLCJwIjoil2FpLWFydGlmaWNpYWwtYW50ZWxsaWdlbmNlZkzMTAwNi9tdXNrLXYtYWx0bWVudWNSb3NpbmctYXJndW1lbnRzLWVudWVx5c2lziwiZXhwIjozNzc5MjMOTUwLCJpYXQiOiE3Nzg4MDQ5NTB9.TXQtcV9vkuuKyqcrMaKtSqql9_wGWeSYgUyO6ZzK-Y Elizabeth Lopatto, reporting for The Verge (gift link): Today was closing arguments in the Musk v. Altman trial, and I almost feel bad writing about the unbelievable demolition derby I just witnessed. Steven Molo, Musk's lawyer, stumbled over his words. He at one point called Greg Brockman ? a co-defendant ? Greg Altman. He erroneously claimed that Musk wasn't asking for money and had to be corrected by the judge. He made it clear we've heard from many liars over the past few weeks, but offered little evidence for Musk's actual legal claims. OpenAI's lawyer, Sarah Eddy, countered this by simply arranging the mountain of evidence that the company introduced in chronological order. She didn't spend time trying to pretend anyone in this trial is especially reliable. She did, however, get the zinger of the day, about Musk: ?Even the mother of his children can't back his story.? William Savitt, who took the defendant

baton after her presentation, demonstrated the number of times Musk ?didn?t recall? some critical detail ? and wondered how a sophisticated businessman couldn?t understand or read a four-page term sheet OpenAI had sent to him. I found myself wondering, again, why we were a...

5. Let?s Run a Neologism Poll

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-15T00:53:54Z

Link: <https://mastodon.social/@gruber/116575825801893849>

After posting the previous item referencing dickpanels , a term I?ve been using since 2022 , it occurred me that they could also be called dickovers (like popovers, but dickheaded). The latter sounds more clever, but I worry it?s less clear. I?m seldom so indecisive, so I?m running a Mastodon poll. ?

6. The Youth AI Safety Institute Has Margrethe Vestager?s Backing

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-15T00:03:13Z

Link: <https://www.euronews.com/next/2026/05/12/margrethe-vestager-backs-new-ai-safety-institute-for-children-after-decade-regulating-big->

Una Hajdari, reporting for Euronews: A new independent institute dedicated to making artificial intelligence safer for children will beformally [sic] presented at the Danish Parliament on Tuesday, with former European Commission executive vice-president Margrethe Vestager among those co-hosting the event. The institute?s approach, as explained in a statement before the launch, is ?modelled on independent crash-test ratings? for cars. The idea, ostensibly, is that just as consumers can check whether a vehicle is safe before buying it, parents should be able to do the same for the AI their children use. Quite what a crash test looks like for a chatbot, the institute does not yet say. Hopefully their AI crash testing winds up more effective than the GDPR ?cookie? initiative overseen by Vestager, which led to the nonsense that required me to click through this ridiculous full-window dickpanel just to read the story. (I love that the dickpanel is titled ?We value your privacy? and then begins with the sentence, ?With your agreement, we and our 399 partners use cookies or similar technologies to store, access, and process personal data like your visit on this website, IP addresses and...

7. A constant-space linear-time algorithm for deleting all but the 10 most recent files in a directory

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 14 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260514-00/?p=112322>

Using data structures you already knew. The post A constant-space linear-time algorithm for deleting all but the 10 most recent files in a directory appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Why do Windows client editions on 32-bit x86 systems artificially limit RAM to 4 GB?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 12 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260512-00/?p=112316>

Compatibility, of course. The post Why do Windows client editions on 32-bit x86 systems artificially limit RAM to 4 GB? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. It?s funny because it?s true

Source: iDiallo.com | Published: Thu, 14 May 2026 07:13:34 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/byte-size/its-funny-because-its-true?src=feed>

I made a joke online. Based on Internet upvote points, it was pretty funny. OK, I didn?t come up with the joke, but it was a perfectly timed reference. A few days back, Cliff Stoll, of the Klein bottles, submitted a post on hackernews titled: Rumors of my death are slightly exaggerated First of all, I was surprised that Cliff frequents hackernews. Second, I didn?t know that he was supposed to be dead. Yet, he wasn?t since he is writing to say that he isn?t dead. Apparently, there was a post on facebook that told his story and claimed that he had died in May of 2024. I was shocked to hear it. I?ve always admired Cliff and his work. But then again, he was the one who posted it on HN. Large language models learn facts by scraping the web, including facebook. So an LLM had ingested this information and regurgitated the

information as fact. Wikipedia also used the facebook post as reference for his death. AI hallucinations are getting ambitious. A couple people recently emailed, asking whether the Klein bottle business was still operating after my death. ?Huh?? I thought. ?I ain?t dead yet.? After some digging, I discovered the source: an AI-generated review of The Cuckoo?s Egg circula...

10. I've finally ported DWiki from Python 2 to Python 3

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-15T00:18:27Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/python/DWikiPython3Now>

DWiki is the pile of code that underlies Wandering Thoughts . It started out many years ago as a Python 2 program (partly because there was no Python 3 at the time), and it stayed that way for a long time , making it the most significant and by far the most substantial Python 2 program I still cared deeply about. Years ago I said I'd port it to Python 3 someday and somewhat to my surprise, that day has now come (well, it came yesterday). The direct trigger was discovering that Python 3.13 had dropped 2to3 , which made me feel that I should run 2to3 over DWiki 's current Python 2 code base while I still could (I had an old conversion from many years ago , but that converted code base was very out of date). One thing led to another, as it often does with me, and I wound up doing a full port and then putting it into production, which is to say serving this blog . I suspect that part of me just felt it was time. (The 2to3 removal is in the Python 3.13 release notes , and it comes after 2to3 and its infrastructure were deprecated in 3.11 for reasonable reasons.) As I expected years ago , the stuff that 2to3 could handle was the easy part. Much of the actual work of the port was sorti...

11. A GNU Emacs learning experience with text-mode hooks

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-14T17:53:00Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/programming/EmacsTextModeHooksGotcha>

For a while, one of my little irritations with my Emacs environment was that sometimes, when I fired up Emacs to edit some code and then quit out of it, Emacs would complain that there was still an ispell process running and ask me what to do with it. This was especially mysterious to me as I don't normally use flyspell-prog-mode (I find it too irritating for general use). Recently I got sufficiently irritated to use a combination of the ELisp debugger and strategic ' (message ...) ' usage to track this down, which initially looked like one issue and actually turned out to be another one that I discovered only as part of writing this entry. One of the major modes in GNU Emacs is text-mode. I have a text-mode hook, probably like many people, and one of the things it does is turn on flyspell-mode in that buffer, which causes flyspell to invoke ispell and thus start an ispell process. It's also my custom from long ago to set the default major mode of buffers to text-mode (the out of the box default is fundamental-mode). If I'm editing something and it's not program source code, it's almost always text and having to say 'M-x text-mode' all the time is the kind of annoyance GNU Emacs i...

12. Going from a ZFS object ID to its path the easier way

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-14T02:53:39Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/solaris/ZFSObjectIdToPath>

It's not uncommon that people using filesystems want to map from an internal object number (an 'inode number' for normal filesystems, an object id or object number in ZFS) to a path. ZFS itself wants to do this efficiently for things like ' zfs diff ' and the ' zpool status ' report on what files are damaged. To help with this, ZFS stores the likely parent object for every normal filesystem object . If you use zdb to do a sufficiently verbose dump of any particular object, you can find this as the 'parent' attribute. If you want to do this mapping yourself, you can use zdb or something like it to manually follow these 'parent' pointers (and also look up the name of everything in its parent directory). However, that would require high privileges, and ZFS doesn't want to make things like ' zpool status ' require that, so the kernel and libzfs expose an API for this. In libzfs, this is ' zpool_obj_to_path() ', which uses the kernel's ZFS_IOC_OBJ_TO_PATH ioctl(). Because it's intended for internal usage, this API doesn't take a pool and filesystem name (in addition to the object ID); instead it takes a

pool handle and a dataset ID. It's up to callers, such as ' zpool status ', to do t...

13. Catch Flakes On Main

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-05-14T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/05/14/catch-flakes-on-main.html>

A small Mechanical Habit today:

14. Building a clock from salvaged Vacuum Fluorescent Displays

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Thu, 14 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/projects/tubeclock/>

When was disassembling an old calculator (as you do) I found these cool VFD tubes: Normally, a whole display is built into a single flat package, which doesn't look particularly interesting. These ones have the individual digits inside a standard vacuum-tube housing, which gives them a cool nixie-esque look. Because vacuum tubes are rather archaic components, they deserve some introduction. The simplest tube has two electrodes: A filament and anode plate. Similar to an old-school lightbulb, the filament is a tungsten wire that heats up when a current passes through it. On a microscopic scale, heat is vibration of atoms which knocks some (negatively charged) electrons out of the wire and into the surrounding space. If the plate has a positive voltage, it attracts some free electrons which allows a current to flow. If the plate is negative, the electrons are repelled and the tube doesn't conduct. This diode configuration is useful for power supplies, but most tubes added a wire mesh or "grid" between the other electrodes. The grid shields the electric field of the plate, so the electrons near the filament only feel the grid's voltage. However, because the grid has a very small ar...

15. Amazonbot is finally respecting robots.txt

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Thu, 14 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/notes/2026/amazonbot-respecting-robots-txt/>

Thanks for giving me a viable business model Amazon!

16. Centrality is not vitality

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-14T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/14/centrality-is-not-vitality.html>

Working through the data behind Weekend at Bernie's and The Mismeasure of Open Source these past couple of weeks, I've been running into the same metric again and again: PageRank applied to package dependency graphs. It turns up in almost every academic paper that wants to say something quantitative about a dependency graph, often as the entire definition of 'criticality' or 'importance' or 'centrality'. It's in every graph library, it produces one number per node, and the graph looks superficially like the web that PageRank was designed for, so it tends to be picked up as the default centrality measure when someone needs one. Pfeiffer's MSR 2021 paper on PageRank and truck factor, Mujahid et al.'s ASE 2023 paper on recommending alternatives to declining npm packages, Tsakpinis and Pretschner's 2024 study of repository accessibility, Chowdhury and Abdalkareem's npm trivial-packages paper, and the recent Maven Central topology analysis all reach for it as a first-class signal, and a great deal of other ecosystem-graph work from the last five years sits in the same territory. Dependency graphs are the strongest structure available for mapping how open source ecosystems actually con...

17. Pluralistic: Kickstarting "The Reverse Centaur's Guide to Life After AI" (14 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 14 May 2026 11:04:43 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/14/who-it-does-it-for/>

Today's links Kickstarting "The Reverse Centaur's Guide to Life After AI": How to be a better AI critic. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: RIP Douglas Adams; R2-trashcan; EFF v W3C; RIP shonky Disneyland; Stolen oligarch forks; Anal fisting site breached; "Reading With Pictures"; "Napier's Bones"; Trump v his base's welfare. Upcoming

appearances: Berlin, Hay-on-Wye, London, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' 'em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Kickstarting "The Reverse Centaur's Guide to Life After AI" (permalink) My next book, The Reverse Centaur's Guide to Life After AI, will be out in about a month ? and (once again) Amazon's monopoly audiobook platform refuses to carry it, and so (once again) I'm pre-selling the audio, ebook and print edition in a Kickstarter campaign that proves that DRM-free isn't just the right way to reach an audience, it's also the best way to reach them:
<https://www.kickstarter.com/projects/doctorow/the-reverse-centaurs-guide-to-life-after-ai>
Reverse Centaur is a book about the realpolitik and the political economy...

18. A few words on DS4

Source: antirez.com | Published: Fri, 15 May 2026 00:22:45 +0200

Link: <http://antirez.com/news/165>

I didn't expect DwarfStar 4 (<https://github.com/antirez/ds4>) to become so popular so fast. It is clear that there was a need for single-model integration focused local AI experience, and that a few things happened together: the release of a quasi-frontier model that is large and fast enough to change the game of local inference, and the fact that it works extremely well with an extremely asymmetric quants recipe of 2/8 bit, so that 96 or 128GB of RAM are enough to run it. And, of course: all the experience produced by the local AI movement in the latest years, that can be leveraged more promptly because of GPT 5.5 (otherwise you can't build DS4 in one week ? and even with all this help you need to know how to gently talk to LLMs). The last week was funny and also tiring, I worked 14 hours per day on average. My normal average is 4/6 since early Redis times, but the first few months of Redis were like that. So, what's next? Is this a project that starts and ends with DeepSeek v4 Flash? Nope, the model can change over time. The space will be occupied, in my vision, by the best current open weights model that is *practically fast* on a high end Mac or ?GPU in a box? gear (like the DG...

19. The Biz Reaper

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-05-14T03:50:47Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17340934/buzzfeed-byron-allen-analysis>

If Byron Allen shows up at your door, you did something wrong with your media business. And BuzzFeed has a visitor. Also: I built a thing.

20. Welcoming the Bahamian Government to Have I Been Pwned

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Thu, 14 May 2026 03:49:29 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/welcoming-the-bahamian-government-to-have-i-been-pwned/>

Today, we welcome the 44th government onboarded to Have I Been Pwned's free gov service: The Bahamas. The National Computer Incident Response Team of The Bahamas, CIRT-BS, now has access to monitor government domains against the data in HIBP. As the national CIRT, CIRT-BS is responsible for coordinating

21. Managed agents are the new Lambda

Source: Martin Alderson | Published: Thu, 14 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: https://martinalderson.com/posts/managed-agents-are-the-new-lambda/?utm_source=rss&utm_medium=rss&utm_campaign=feed

Managed agents (cloud-hosted agent harnesses) are powerful, but locking yourself into a frontier lab's platform now is risky - here's why and what to do instead.

22. The First Democratic Tech Alliance Assembly

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 14 May 2026 16:17:12 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/democratic-tech-alliance-may-2026/>

Yesterday I attended the first assembly of the Democratic Tech Alliance (DTA), which gathered in the European Parliament. Membership of the alliance includes European political groups like the Greens/EFA, the liberal/center right Renew Europe, the European People's Party of Christian

democratic, conservative and liberal-conservative persuasion and also the Progressive Alliance of Socialists and Democrats. This is a broad, quite sane and actually impressive collection of political groups, which gives me some hope.

23. Galileo's Ground Segment Problem

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Mon, 19 Oct 2020 13:55:02 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/galileos-ground-segment-problem/>

The European Global Navigation Satellite System Galileo has recently been suffering from frequent "almost disruptions", most likely partially due to Corona, and possibly also due to Brexit, but in any case due to some historical stinginess. Before I explain what is going on, I should hasten to say that most days of the week, Galileo is working well for most users. But for example, Monday the 28th of September, one satellite was off by a stunning 5 meters.

24. GNSS Jamming and Spoofing, aka Galileo's Authentication Algorithm Part 3

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 13 Sep 2020 11:49:53 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/galileos-authentication-algorithm-part-3/>

Welcome to part 3 of my series on OSNMA, the proposed Galileo Navigation Message Authentication protocol. This part can be read independently from part 1 and part 2, but it might be useful to read the introduction to part 1. This post attempts to explain GPS (GNSS) jamming and spoofing, so it might be a useful read even if you don't care about Galileo or its authentication. As usual, I've been helped tremendously by Daniel Estøvez & many other researchers and Galileo professionals, and again I am very grateful for all the links, corrections, suggestions and knowledge you provided.